DIGITAL SKILLS
FOR BUSINESS



AI in Action: Prompts, Automation Workflows, Admin Efficiency

Virtual workshop

Wednesday, Jan. 21, from 10 a.m. to noon

Register today!

GEORGINA · EG East Gwillimbury · ySpace · YORK UNIVERSITÉ UNIVERSITY

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AI in Action: Prompts, Automation & Admin Efficiency

Diana Isaza Shelton

Senior User Experience Researcher & Strategic Partner | Pathfinder AI

Daniel Isaza Barrantes

CEO and Co-owner of Evernet S.A.S. & Strategic Partner | Pathfinder AI

Jan 21, 2026



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What we'll cover in this session

- Common pain points for entrepreneurs
- Crafting effective AI prompts
- Automating workflows (no tech skills needed)
- Actionable AI case studies
- Ways to start implementing AI: Start today



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Meet Your Guide

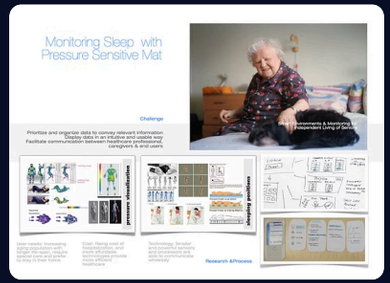
- User Experience Designer and Researcher
- Mom of three boys - sports mom
- Love water
- Bilingual music creator
- Master's degree in Design
- 12 years at IBM
- Consulting in multiple industries



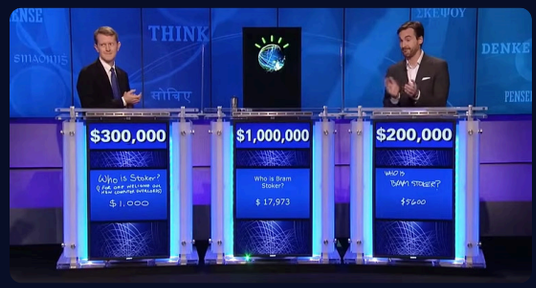




Carleton University







PATHFINDER AI

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KEY INSIGHT

Why This Matters for Small Business *Now*

The Reality

Business owners juggle many roles: customer service, marketing, finance, strategy. Time is your scarcest resource.

The AI Advantage

- Save hours on repetitive tasks
- Focus on strategy
- Compare options instantly
- Make faster, informed decisions



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Reflection: How are you currently using AI in your business today, if at all?

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A Mindset Shift: empower YOU, not replace YOU

- AI is your powerful assistant.
- You retain full control.
- Your expertise drives final decisions.

> "AI is the intern you always wanted–fast, tireless, and occasionally confused."

Important reality check: AI isn't magic. It predicts patterns based on massive amounts of data. Sometimes it "hallucinates"–meaning it generates confident-sounding answers that are completely wrong.



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Common Pain Points for Entrepreneurs

Entrepreneurs face shared time-draining challenges. AI offers solutions.



Admin Overload

Paperwork, emails, and documentation consume productive hours.



Scheduling Chaos

Endless emails for appointments and reminders.



Repetitive Tasks

Daily repetitive tasks ripe for automation.



Customer Questions

Repeated customer inquiries across channels.



Marketing Content

Creating consistent marketing content.



Bookkeeping

Tracking expenses, invoicing, and records.

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Reflection: Which of these challenges costs you the most time each week?



Admin Overload

Paperwork, emails, and documentation consume productive hours.



Scheduling Chaos

Endless emails for appointments and reminders.



Repetitive Tasks

Daily repetitive tasks ripe for automation.



Customer Questions

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A Perspective on a Journey to Adopt AI

Everyday AI

Your thinking partner for writing, learning, and problem-solving. Save hours on research and drafting.

AI as a Team Member

Automate workflows and repetitive tasks. AI handles scheduling, follow-ups, and communications.

AI Behind the Scenes

Advanced background automation and data analysis. Connect and integrate your tools.

Pro tip: Start small. Choose one area, experiment, and expand as you gain confidence.

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PART 1

Everyday AI: Your Thinking Assistant

No coding, no complex setup–just start a conversation and watch your productivity multiply.

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PART 1

Everyday AI: Your Thinking Assistant

Familiar AI Tools

ChatGPT, Google Gemini, Claude: conversational AI assistants, free to start, no technical skills needed.

AI capabilities are also integrating into tools you already use.

How AI Assists

- **Emails & Messages:** Draft professional replies instantly.
- **Summaries & Notes:** Condense documents to key points.
- **Checklists & Plans:** Structure action plans efficiently.
- **Learning:** Grasp new topics quickly with clear explanations.

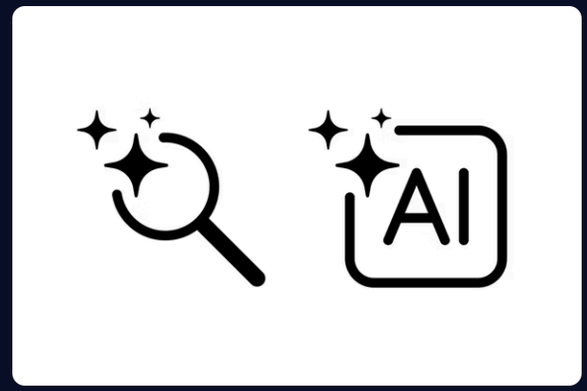
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AI is Everywhere...

AI is transforming familiar tools and democratizing digital creation, making powerful capabilities accessible to everyone.

Embedded in Tools We Already Use

AI integrations in platforms like **Google Workspace, Figma, Canva, and Microsoft Office** streamline tasks, suggest content, and automate designs.



In New No-Code/Low-Code Revolution

Tools like **Gamma and Lovable** empower non-technical users transform the way we build presentations, websites, and applications.

Keep an eye out!

Monitor new AI features in the tools you already use.

Dare to try!

Explore new AI tools with free trials to see their potential.

Experiment widely!

Integrate AI at every stage of your creative process.

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Key Skill: Prompting (How You Talk to AI)

Clear Instructions are Key

Clear instructions directly impact the quality of AI results.

Three Essential Elements

AI needs: **Context** (your situation), **Clarity** (what you want), and **Constraints** (length, tone, format).

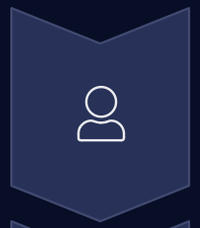
Delegate Like a Pro

Brief AI as you would a smart intern: provide background, explain the task, set boundaries, and describe the desired outcome.

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Pathfinder's 4-Step Prompt Framework

This 4-step framework turns vague ideas into powerful, actionable AI prompts.



Define the Role & Context

Tell AI its role and your situation. Example: "You're a marketing consultant for a local bakery."



Specify the Task Clearly

State your exact need. Example: "Create three social media posts for our new gluten-free line."



Add Details & Constraints

Add specific boundaries and requirements. Example: "Under 150 characters, friendly tone, include emoji."

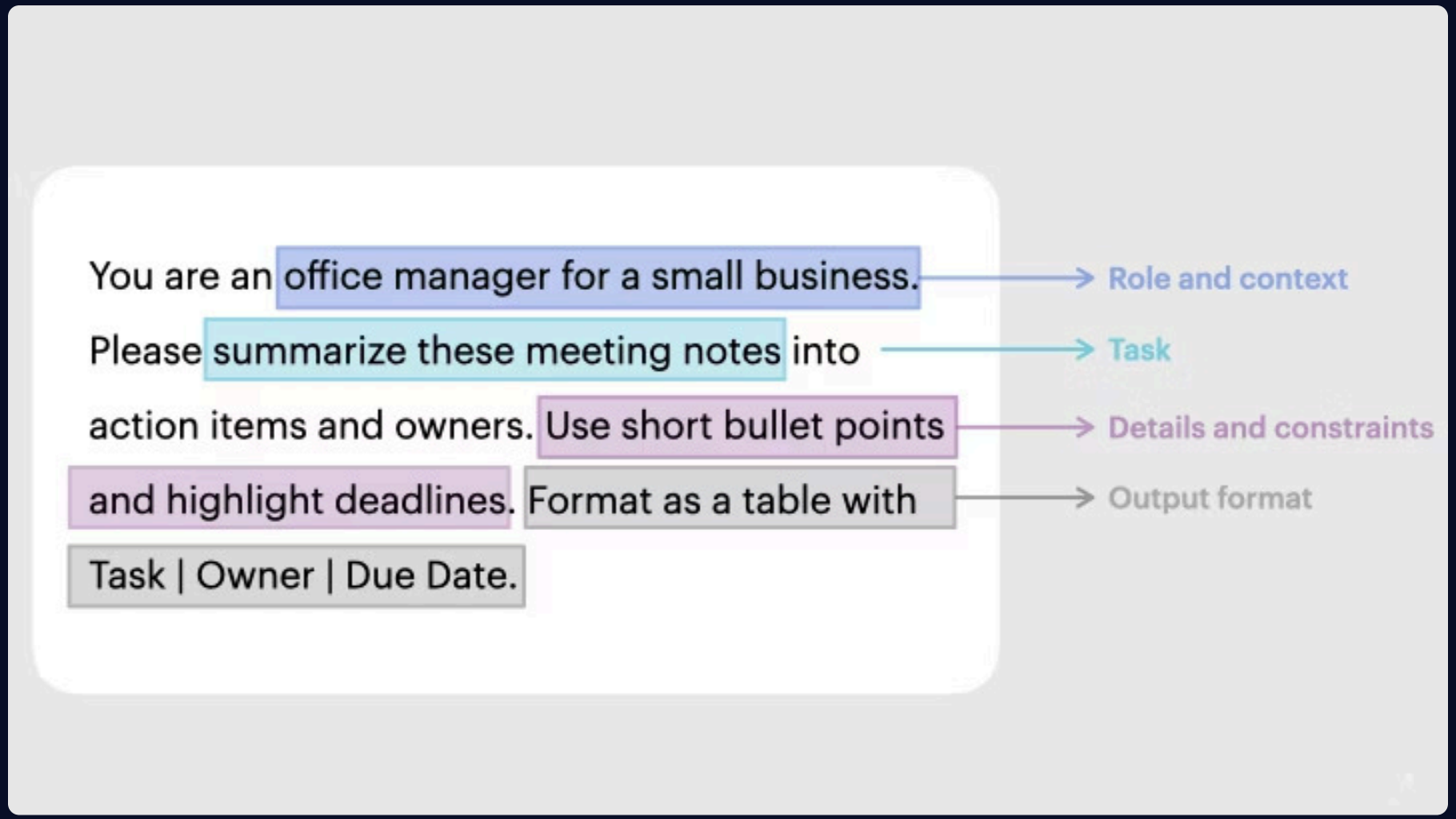


Define the Output Format

Describe the desired output format. Example: "Table with columns for platform, text, and hashtags."

Pro tip: Master prompting for exponential AI utility. **"AI isn't bad at work – it's bad at guessing."** Clear prompts save hours on revisions.

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Pro tip: Leverage prompt libraries for small business owners and entrepreneurs. Ask ChatGPT to help you craft a good prompt.

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Prompt Examples

See how transforming **vague requests** into **structured prompts** unlocks powerful AI assistance.



Marketing

❌ **Vague:**

“Write a post about my bakery.”

✅ **Improved:**

You are a marketing consultant for a neighbourhood bakery. Create 3 Instagram posts promoting our new gluten-free muffins. Keep them under 120 words, friendly and upbeat, include one emoji per post. Format as a numbered list.



Real Estate

❌ **Vague:**

“Write me an email to buyers.”

✅ **Improved:**

You are a real estate assistant helping a busy agent. Write a follow-up email to buyers who toured a home yesterday. Keep it warm and professional, under 150 words, and include a call to action to book a second showing. Format as a ready-to-send email.

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Everyday AI: Specialized knowledge

Context and guardrails transform AI into your specialized business advisor.

Explore Existing GPTs

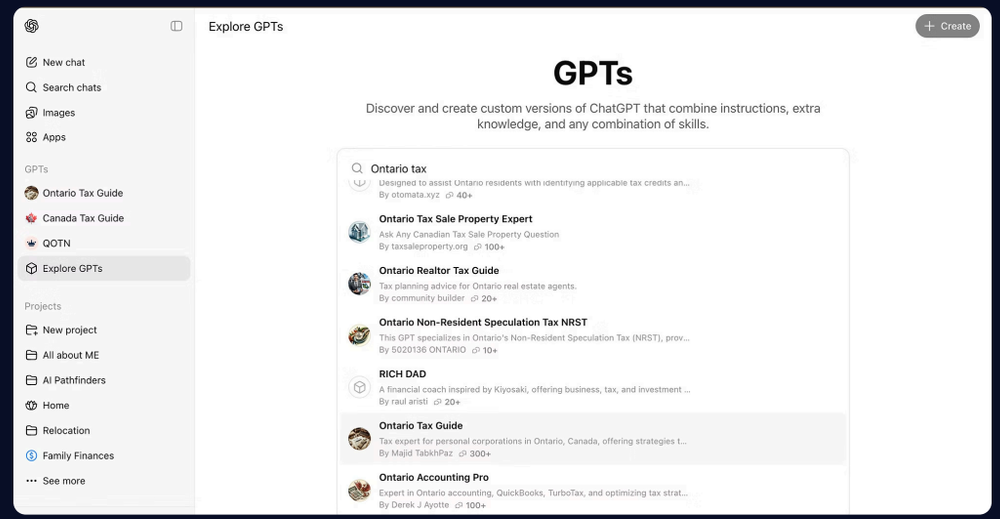
Discover pre-built assistants in the GPT marketplace.

Create Your Own

Build Custom GPTs with tailored knowledge and guardrails. No coding.

Add Context

Upload documents, set guidelines, and refine AI responses.



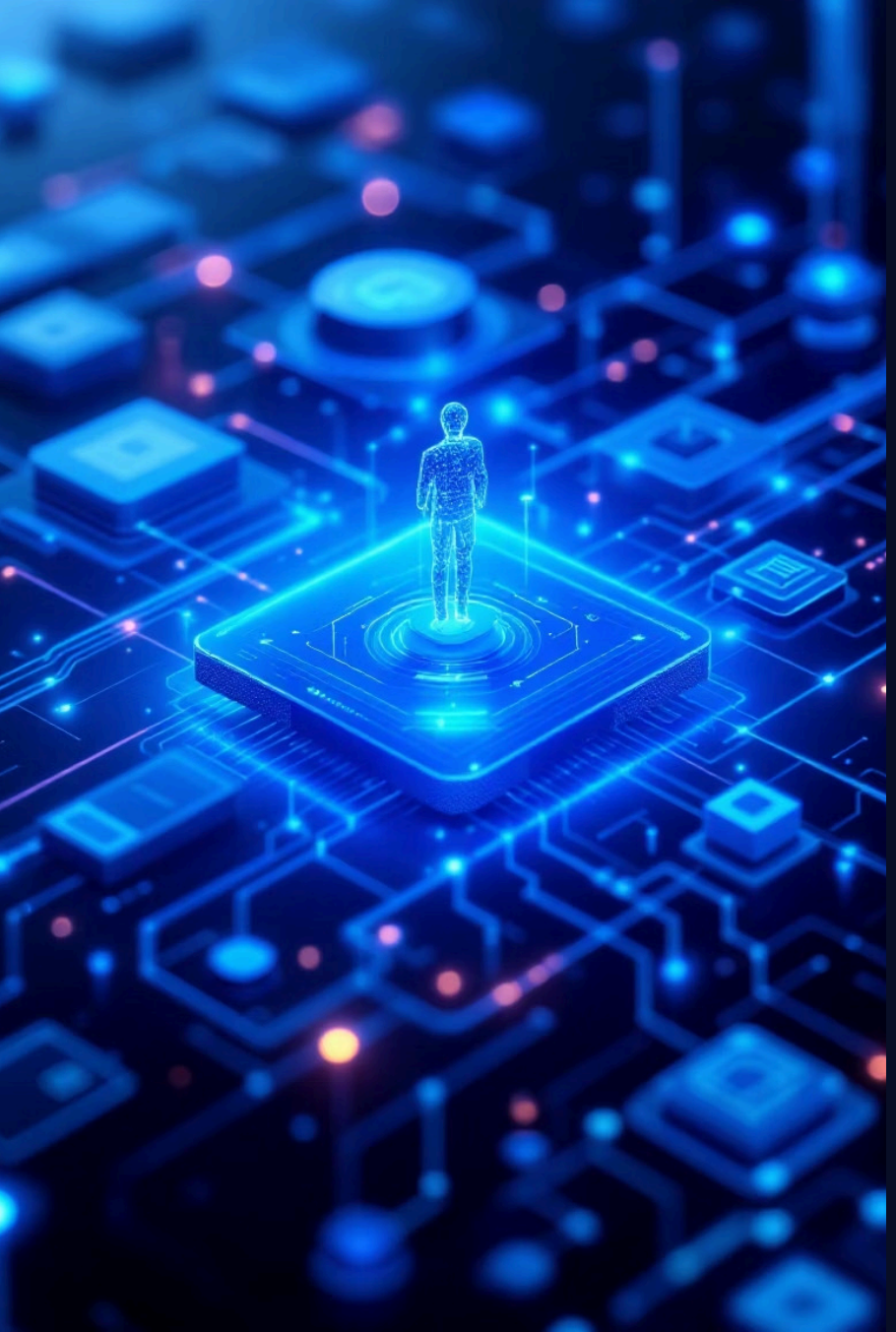
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AI in Action: An New Entrepreneur Looking for Specialized Tax Knowledge

Google Docs

Sarah CustomGPTs.mp4

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PART 2

AI as a Team Member: Streamlining Your Workflows

Chat tools like ChatGPT help *you* work faster. But workflows help your entire *business* run smoother.

> An AI chat or feature is the brain. Workflows are the nervous system.

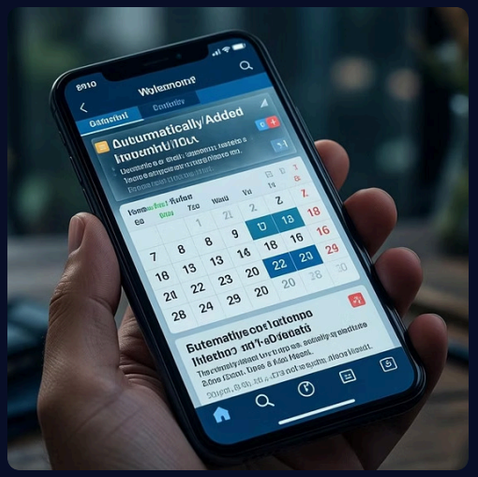
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Automations You Might Already Use

You're experiencing the power of automation more than you think.



Voice Assistants



Calendar Sync + Reminders



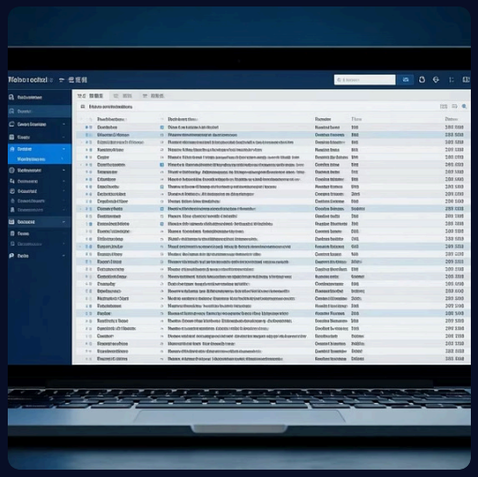
Smart Lighting



Smart Appliances



Streaming Autoplay



Email Filters

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PART 2

Reflection: What automations do you already have set up?

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AI in Action: An AI Workflow to Help Grandma

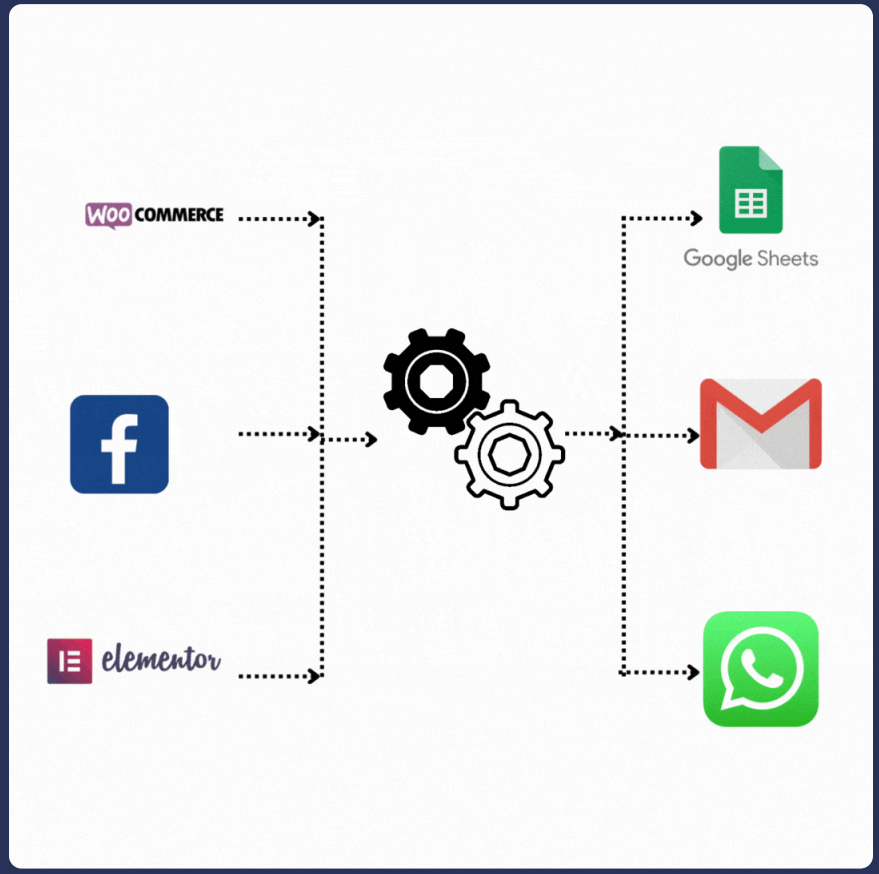
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Automation for Grandma Appointments.mp4

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DEFINITION

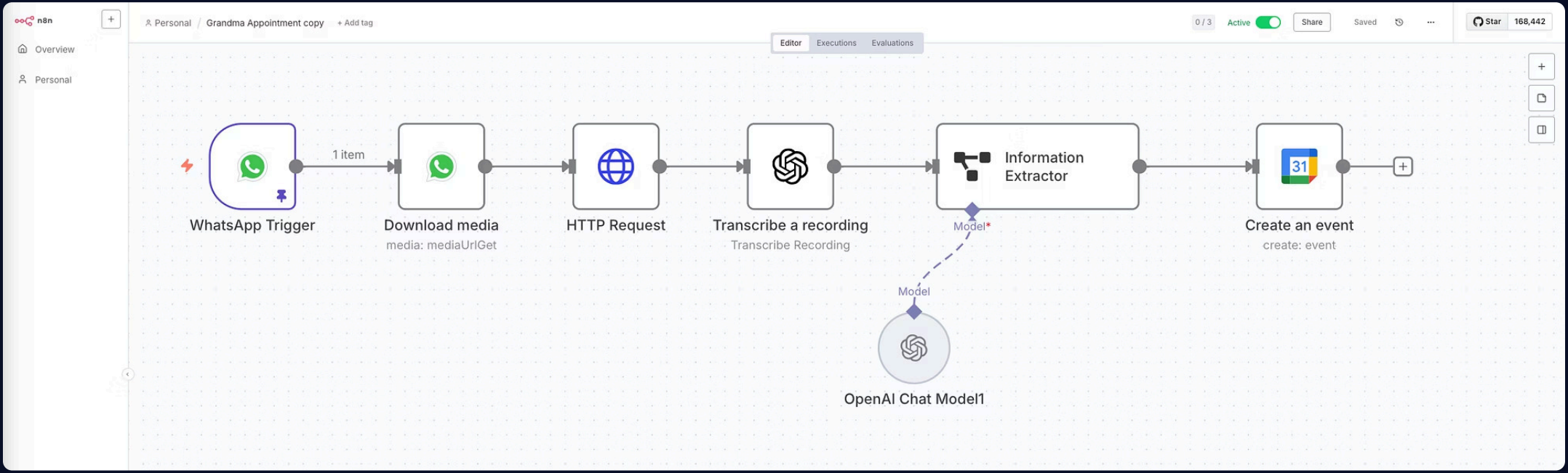
A workflow is a series of repeated steps executed automatically—set once, run forever.



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PART 2

What is happening in the background?



"No-code" tools like n8n and **Make** allows you to visually connect different systems. Drag-and-drop interfaces mean no programming knowledge is needed.

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AI in Action: An AI Virtual Front Desk in a Wellness Clinic

Google Docs

Wellness clinic.mp4

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Workflow: The AI-Virtual Administrator



Customer Message

Incoming message received.

AI Summarizes & Classifies

AI analyzes, extracts key info, classifies intent.

Information Stored

Relevant data stored securely.

Automated Follow-Up

Personalized email sent.

Team Notified

Team members notified of action.

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PART 2

Reflection: Look at your business tasks, processes in your day to day operations. Where are you repeating the same steps? That's your automation opportunity.

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PART 3

AI Behind the Scenes: Admin Efficiency

AI transforms daily admin tasks, freeing your team's time and resources.

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AI Behind the Scenes: Unlocking New Possibilities

01

Analyze Complex Information

Process vast data, identify patterns, and extract insights.

02

Decide Optimal Next Steps

Recommend and execute logical, efficient actions.

03

Classify Diverse Requests

Categorize inquiries and route to correct departments.

04

Engage via Voice or Chat

Interact with users through natural language interfaces.



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DEFINITION

An AI Agent is a digital worker that thinks, decides, and acts autonomously across your business tools.

While a **workflow** executes fixed steps, an **AI agent** is dynamic:

- Understands your intent.
- Interacts with systems to complete tasks.
- Adapts actions across your business tools.



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AI in Action: A Voice Agent for Real Estate Professionals

Google Docs

VoiceChat Real State with demo.mov

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How is the Agent Set Up?

Tools like **ElevenLabs and n8n** make it easy to build a custom agent. Whether chat-based or voice-activated, your agent can be trained on your business knowledge and configured to:

- Gather initial customer information and qualify leads
- Respond to FAQ instantly
- Route inquiries to the right team member
- Schedule follow-up appointments or callbacks

Google Docs

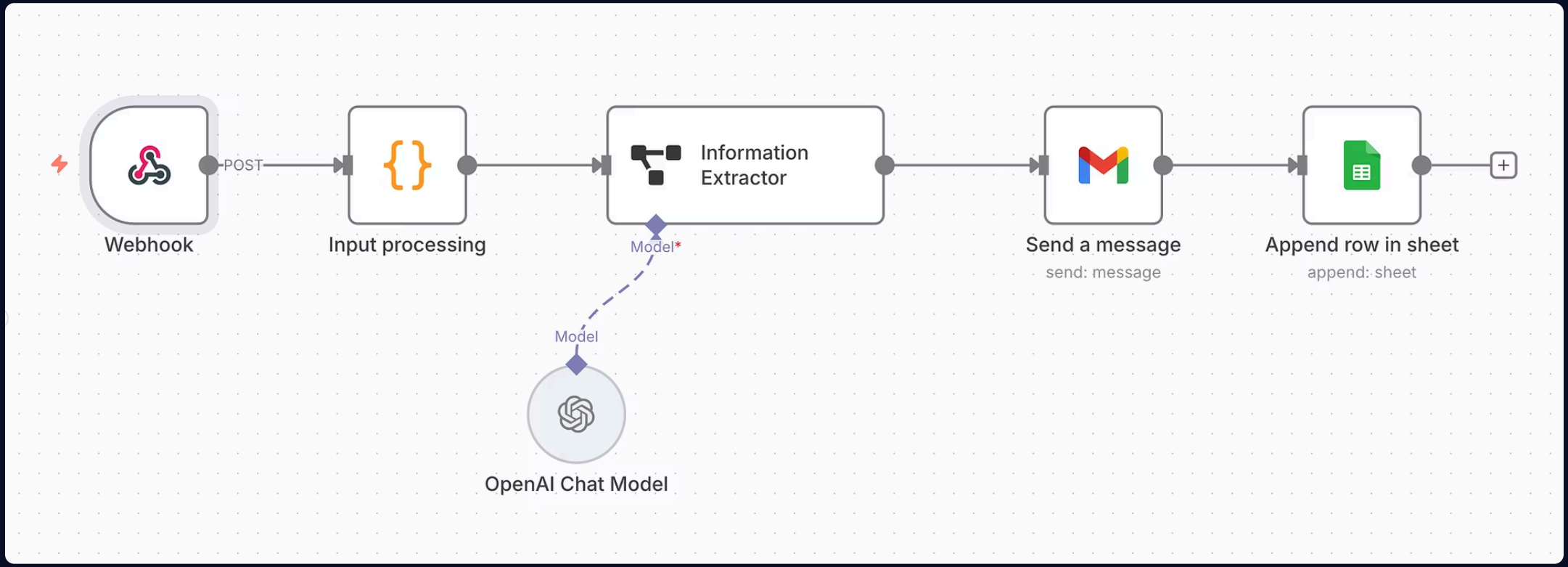
ElevenLabsAgentSetup Demo.mp4

And much more—all without human intervention

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What is Happening Behind the Scenes

A simple flow where AI reads incoming requests, pulls out key details, sends a response, and saves everything in your database automatically.



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Sends a message to the Sales Department at Urban Hive Real Estate

Asunto New Purchase Inquiry – Diana Moore

Dear Sales Department,

This message is to formally notify you of a new purchase inquiry received through the AI Real Estate Assistant.

The prospective client, **Diana Moore**, has expressed interest in a residential property with the following details:

- **Client Name:** Diana Moore
- **Phone Number:** 123-456-7899
- **Email:** diana.moore@gmail.com
- **Property Description:** Three-bedroom, three-bathroom apartment
- **Location:** 2700 John Street, Markham
- **Estimated Price:** CAD 976,500

The client has been qualified by the AI assistant and is ready to be contacted by a sales specialist to continue the purchasing process, provide additional information, and coordinate next steps.

Please proceed with the follow-up at your earliest convenience to ensure a timely response and an optimal client experience.

Should you require any additional details or supporting information, please do not hesitate to reach out.

Kind regards,
Urban Hive Real Estate
AI Real Estate Assistant

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Adds Prospective Client to a Database



Client Name	Phone Number	Email	Property / Location	#	Specialist Confirmed	Price (CAD)
Michael Thompson	905-214-7834	m.thompson@gmail.com	Two-bedroom condo – Newmarket (Yonge St & Davis Dr)	Yes		512,000
Sarah McAllister	416-902-4471	sarah.mcallister@hotmail.com	One-bedroom apartment – Richmond Hill (Hillcrest Mall area)	No		0
Andrew Collins	647-381-2295	andrew.collins@hotmail.com	Three-bedroom townhouse – Aurora (Bayview Ave)	Yes		685,000
Emily Robertson	905-667-5409	emily.robertson@gmail.com	One-bedroom condo – Vaughan Metropolitan Centre	Yes		438,000
Jason Patel	416-770-1186	j.patel@yahoo.com	Investment condo – Markham (Warden Ave & Hwy 7)	No		0
Laura Bennett	905-993-6712	laura.bennett@outlook.com	Two-bedroom apartment – East Gwillimbury	No		0
Kevin O'Donnell	647-554-9033	kevin.odonnell@yahoo.com	Three-bedroom detached house – Georgina (Keswick)	Yes		742,000
Priya Shah	416-845-6621	priyashah@apple.com	Pre-construction condo inquiry – Vaughan	No		0
Robert Sinclair	905-311-4802	r.sinclair@gmail.com	Two-bedroom condo – Richmond Hill (Yonge & Major Mackenzie)	Yes		559,000
Diana Moore	647-290-7718	diana.moore@gmail.com	Three-bedroom, three-bathroom apartment – 2700 John Street, Markham	Yes		976,500
Daniel Fraser	905-428-6190	d.fraser@apple.com	Luxury three-bedroom apartment – Markham (Downtown)	Yes		985,000
Natalie Brooks	416-633-5094	natalie.brooks@gmail.com	Rental inquiry – Newmarket	No		0

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Bringing It All Together



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A Perspective on a Journey to Adopt AI



Everyday AI

Your thinking partner for writing, learning, and problem-solving. Save hours on research and drafting.



AI as a Team Member

Automate workflows and repetitive tasks. AI handles scheduling, follow-ups, and communications.



AI Behind the Scenes

Advanced background automation and data analysis. Connect and integrate your tools.

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PART 3

Reflection: Your First AI Use Case

Consider AI's benefits for your daily workflow.

1

What Task Drains Your Time Daily?

Identify a recurring task that consumes a significant portion of your day.

2

Which Part is Repetitive?

Pinpoint the most monotonous or routine element within that task.

3

What Outcome Would Help Most?

Envision the ideal result if this task or element were automated by AI.



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PART 3

Real-World Impact: Case Studies of AI in Action

Explore other case studies in our library















Retail Efficiency

WhatsApp replies are now **80% faster** with AI assistance.

Real Estate Insights

Voice-to-summary workflows **streamline property management.**

Wellness Clinic

A **virtual front desk** manages appointments and inquiries, enhancing patient experience.

Recruiting Automation

AI-powered candidate screening **reduces hiring time** and effort.

Marketing Precision

Subscriber segmentation leads to more targeted and effective campaigns.

Finance & Bookkeeping

An AI power assistant to reconcile accounts and categorize expenses automatically.

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Pathfinder Blueprint: Your AI Adoption Path

1

Identify Repetitive Tasks

Find tasks where AI adds immediate value.

2

Learn Prompting

Master communication with AI models.

3

Implement Simple Workflows

Start with easy, high-impact automations.

4

Advance Automation

Gradually integrate complex AI as confidence grows.

5

Maintain & Improve

Monitor and refine AI workflows for peak performance.

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Tools to Start With: Your AI Toolkit

Accessible tools to kickstart your AI journey.



ChatGPT / Claude / Gemini

AI conversational models for content, summarization, and analysis.



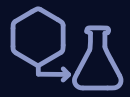
n8n or Make

No-code automation: connect apps, automate tasks.



Lovable / Gamma / Canva

Create simple apps, pages, or sites without coding.



ElevenLabs

Text-to-speech: realistic voice generation and agents.

Start with one tool, one task. Simplicity is key for initial success and learning.

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Final Takeaways & Call to Action

AI is a Skill, Not a Threat

Embrace AI as a tool to augment your capabilities, not replace them.

Start Small, Experiment Often

Begin with manageable projects and iterate based on what you learn.

Don't Wait to Be "Ready"

The best time to learn and implement AI is now.

Be Open, Let it Surprise you

Learn new concepts, challenge your own ways of doing things.

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Your Next Steps:

- Complete the workshop **survey.**
- **Download this presentation** for deeper insights or access this link in your browser.
- Try a new AI prompt this week. **See prompt library.**
- Identify a tedious or repetitive task in your workflow.
- Explore **n8n workflow templates site** and try "Learn by doing" for beginners.
- Check out the **use cases** for real world examples.
- Connect with Pathfinder AI for personalized guidance.

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Feeling curious? Keep learning...

Watch **AI Agents, Clearly Explained** | by Jeff Su

Watch **How AI Agents work** | by Maya Murad IBM

Take **Google AI Essentials Specialization** Free Course in Coursera

Take **Make Automation Tutorial for beginners** by Kevin Stratvert

Try **Gamma for free** - This presentation is made with Gamma at no cost. It will blow you away!

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Pathfinder AI guides



Diana Isaza Shelton

https://www.linkedin.com/in/diana-isaza-shelton/

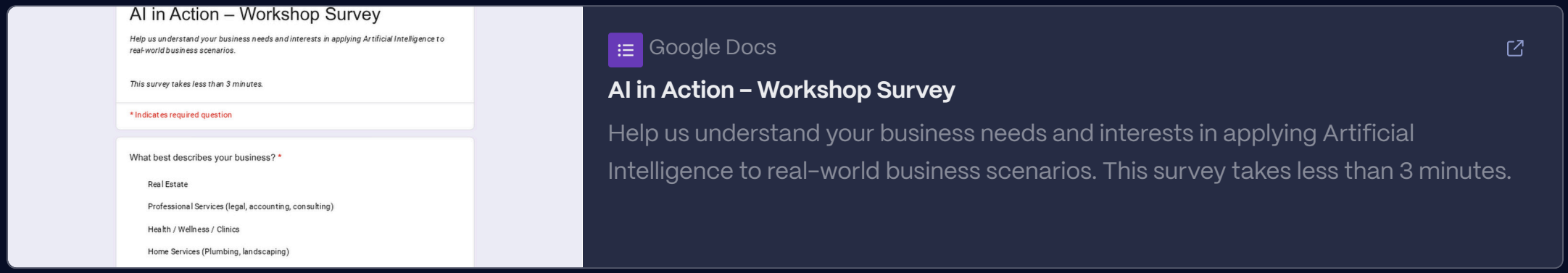


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AI In Action: Workshop Survey



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